Ancient Rock Paintings

In India, we can see many paintings in rocks and caves. The rock paintings give some information about the past. Approximately there are 750 caves, in which 500 caves have paintings. There are many more undiscovered caves. The rock paintings depict hunting pictures of the male and the female, dancing pictures and pictures of children playing.

Tamilini: Oh! We are able to gain some knowledge about the past lifestyle through these paintings. Isn't it, Grandma?

Grandma: You said it rightly, Tamil. These rock and cave paintings tell us many stories about our ancestors.

Tamilini: Okay, grandma! Now tell me how humans reached the next stage.

Grandma: There were many dangers involved in hunting. Due to large-scale hunting in the mountain areas and in the forests, many animals became extinct. Non availability of meat forced the humans to look for fruits and vegetables for food.

Tamilini: Now they would have thought of producing food for themselves. Is it not grandma?

From Nomadic to Settled Life : The World's Earliest Farmers

Grandma: Very well said, Tamil. The seed of fruits and the nuts they ate were thrown into the soil. During rains, the soil gave it life. Some days later, the saplings sprouted from the soil. By observation and logic, they learn that:

a. a plant grows from a single seed and yields lots of fruits and vegetables.
b. seeds that fall in the river beds sprout easily.
c. plants grow faster in water fed areas.
d. alluvial soil is more suitable for plant growth than any other.

With the above knowledge they gained, they realised that with proper sowing and nurturing, they could increase the number of plants more than the ones that grew naturally. Thus agriculture and farming came into existence. They domesticated the animals and used them in their farming.



Breeding of animals now became an important part of their life. Oxen were used for ploughing. Oxen made the practice of agriculture easier. Life was becoming organised than it was, when they were hunting. It enabled them to settle down in a place. Now with settlement came the problem of utensils and vessels for cooking and storage. The potter's wheel and fire solved this problem.

The invention of plough helped the farming practices. Farming started with the clearing of land and burning the left-over shrubs. They ploughed the land, sowed seeds in them and harvested the produce.